PLAYBOOK · TIME FENCES

Change the plan late, pay twice

A planning playbook for production and supply planners

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SUPPLY CHAIN 101 · TIME FENCE

What a time fence is

- An agreed line in the calendar
- It sets how freely the plan may change
- Closer to today means harder to change

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STEP 1 · SET THE ZONES

Frozen, slushy, liquid

- Frozen, weeks 1 to 2: named approver only
- Slushy, weeks 3 to 4: inside agreed limits
- Liquid, beyond: replan freely

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STEP 2 · PRICE THE BREAK

Every late change has a bill

- Extra changeovers and overtime
- Bumped orders for other SKUs
- Rushed packaging and materials

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STEP 3 · MEASURE · ILLUSTRATIVE

Track schedule adherence

- Batches made as planned ÷ batches planned
- Illustrative: 34 of 40 batches = 85%
- Review it weekly with sales and production

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STEP 4 · LEARN

Log every fence break

- One reason and one approver per break
- Same reason twice? Fix the process
- Check in 30 days: are breaks falling?

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THE TAKEAWAY

A plan that always moves is a wish

Save this for your next review.

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